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January 1

"We keep what we have only with vigilance...."

Gray Book p. 87 (Chapter 6, Header)

Vigilance means "stay alert". Much like soldiers who keep watch that the enemy does not advance, addicts recovering from the disease of addiction must also keep watch over ourselves. We take this action daily, so the addiction does not advance and claim more spiritual territory within us. We work and live the spiritual principles of the twelve steps and twelve traditions as we renew our commitment to our recovery daily. Our daily reprieve is contingent on this spiritual conditioning.

Our surrender to the program of Narcotics Anonymous leads to a spiritual awakening. If we are not vigilant our spirits may regress and we will be susceptible to relapses.

The steps of Narcotics Anonymous are suggested, therefore varies by individual. The traditions of Narcotics Anonymous are our protection from ourselves; therefore, ought not to be negotiated.

Narcotics Anonymous groups must stay vigilant. The traditions are our first line of defense. Practicing our traditions in our groups and service committees keeps the disease from infiltrating our gatherings. Our traditions not only protect us from ourselves, but from outside forces as well.

A Higher Power is the only ultimate authority in Narcotics Anonymous as it is expressed through group conscience. This "good orderly direction"

and adherence to the spiritual principles will keep us alert and ensure our survival and the survival of Narcotics Anonymous.

In This Moment: We keep our spirits awake and vigilant by the application of spiritual principles embodied in the Narcotics Anonymous program.

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January 2

"When we pray a remarkable thing happens; we find the means, the ways, and energies to perform tasks far beyond our capabilities." Gray Book p. 58 L: 23-25, Step Eleven)

The first step in Narcotics Anonymous asks us to admit our powerlessness and unmanageability over the disease of addiction. In the second step we are asked to tap into a power greater than ourselves to relieve our obsession to use. In the third step, we make a decision to turn our will and our lives over to God, as we understand God, for guidance and care. The foundation built from these first three steps is what makes recovery possible.

In step eleven, we are suggested to ask for power; the power we ask for is not for power over addiction. The power we are now asking for is knowledge of God's will for us and the power to carry that out to keep us growing. We ask for the power to live the steps and practice these principles in our daily lives. Without this power we cannot and will not continue this spiritual journey. If we do not, we will return to the hopeless condition we were in when we first found NA. With this power we are transformed into a better condition than we were in before active addiction.

It takes prayer and meditation to align our thinking and actions with the ultimate power greater than ourselves. The result will be a better understanding of the world, ourselves, and others than we ever had. The ordinary becomes extraordinary. Our liabilities are minimized and our assets enhanced. We become a tool to help ourselves and others. We are no longer just existing. For the first time we are fully living happy, joyous, and free.

In This Moment: We will continue to seek guidance Through prayer and meditation. A conscious contact with a God of our own understanding is what makes our recovery possible.

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January 3

"The Eleventh Step helps us, in the face of a problem, to be aware of God."

Gray Book p. 58 (Step Eleven, L: 10-11)

By the time we get to step eleven, most of us have reached an awareness that we are not alone. We experience and feel the power that first got us clean is still with us today. Throughout our journey, we have experienced miracles we could not explain.

We have experienced strength and courage to go through life on its own terms without using drugs or creating unmanageability in our lives. In our fellowship, we see evidence of the same power at work in the lives of others.

We see newcomers stay clean and hope return, as their lives are transformed. We also experience peace of mind and serenity we never knew before. Our Gray Book states: "We begin to find peace unmatched to a drug-induced high." We improve and depend on our relationship with the God of our understanding through the good times as well as in the difficult times.

Our seventh step reminds us that humility is a good state for an addict to be in. Reliance on God assures that we are not alone. Anonymity means that we cannot do this ourselves. We no longer by work the steps just to stay clean even though that is necessary. We live the steps to experience the spiritual awakenings we have witnessed within the fellowship. Our awareness helps us not to forget that in the midst of a storm, our Higher Power is there waiting and willing to help us, if we reach out.

In This Moment: We will not forget the power that got us clean is still with us. Our Higher Power will continue to be with us on this journey, if we invite it.

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January 4

"...we can finally look others in the eye and be grateful for who we are."

Gray Book p. 142 (Chapter Eight L. 13-24)

For most of us, active addiction filled us with shame and remorse, partially because of the things we had to do to obtain our drugs. We walked with our heads down in shame, and would not look straight ahead because we might have caught someone's eyes looking at us. We stopped looking people straight in the eyes because we felt they might see our guilt and shame. We did not look up because that meant we would must acknowledge God, symbolically anyway.

We knew deep down inside we were not well, but we were powerless. After arriving to Narcotics Anonymous and getting clean, we found we were not alone. We met members that suffered and felt like us. They hugged us, looked in our eyes, and told us we did not have to suffer alone anymore. We felt an empathy that we never knew existed.

With the help of God, our sponsors, and step work our shame was lifted. Our fifth step revealed that we were only human with a disease. For the first time in a very long time, we could look another person in the eyes and feel a part of. Our eighth and ninth steps provided a way out of that shame.

We are given the opportunity to amend our past. We are now able to walk with our heads held high. We can now look people in the eyes and up to our God with humility.

In This Moment: Today we have acceptance of who we are. We will continue to improve with the help of God and Narcotics Anonymous.

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January 5

"In our experience, the Twelve steps give us a way of life which does more than keep us off drugs."

Gray Book p. 159 (Chapter Ten L 2-3)

In the first step we find we are powerless over addiction. Narcotics Anonymous is not a drug program; it is a living program. We recover from a hopeless state of mind, body, and spirit that makes up the disease of addiction. Maintaining total and complete abstinence is the cornerstone of the NA program but Narcotics Anonymous is much more than simple abstinence.

Since addiction is much more than just using drugs, our recovery must be more than just remaining clean. "I'm not using drugs. Now what?" Addicts must practice spiritual principles in every area of their lives.

As we live the spiritual principles within in our steps and traditions, our spirits awaken; and we find the benefits of the spiritual fruits the steps and traditions embody. We find a God of our own understanding and we develop a relationship with that God. We have the opportunity for spiritual growth with no limitations.

We share this precious gift with others as we carry the message to the addict who still suffers. We awaken others as we are awakened. We also have the opportunity of freedom from self-bondage the disease had kept us in. As a result, we are also given freedom from other people's control over us. The spiritual principles of Narcotics Anonymous can be accessed, if we work for them.

In This Moment: The Narcotics Anonymous program helps make the world a much better place to live in, for us and for those around us. We begin seeing the full benefits of the twelve steps and twelve traditions and not limit them to just not using drugs.

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January 6

"...we believe that every addict, including the 'potential' addict, suffers from an incurable disease of body, mind and spirit."

Gray Book p. iv (Introduction, Last Paragraph)

In Narcotics Anonymous, we view addiction as a spiritual malady, not a medical problem. Our literature tells us that addiction is made up of two components, obsession and compulsion. Our drug use was just a symptom of those components. Since a spiritual problem cannot be treated with medication, our solution has to be of a spiritual nature.

Narcotics Anonymous views and treats addiction as a threefold disease; physical, mental, and spiritual. Our spiritual solution begins by treating the physical compulsion through complete and total abstinence in the first step. We physically go to meetings, as an act of surrender, and do not use any drugs for any reason. We treat the obsession to use drugs in the second step by tapping into a power greater than ourselves. The process of coming to believe is what restores us to sanity. In the third step, we decide to allow the God of our own understanding, care and guide us by continuing to live the Narcotics Anonymous program.

We are granted a daily reprieve from this progressive, fatal, incurable disease. We begin to live drug free lives. Narcotics Anonymous is more than not using drugs. By practicing the principles of the steps and the traditions and sharing this precious gift, we get to live happy, joyous and free.

In This Moment: We must use a spiritual solution for our threefold disease and share this message with others.

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January 7

"Not only is this way of life superior to the old using life, it is superior to any life that we can conceive."

Gray Book p. 159 (Chapter Ten L 3-5)

Some people say that recovery and Narcotics Anonymous leaves the person in a better condition than they were in before they even got sick. Narcotics Anonymous not only offers freedom from active addiction, but it offers spiritual awakenings as a result of working and living each step. We learn a new way of life that most addicts could not even conceive of. It offers freedom from our self-imposed prisons. This way of life releases us from bondage of self and from others.

Through working in living the spiritual principles of the steps and the traditions, we learn how to accept and love ourselves. We learn how to build healthy relationships with ourselves and others and society at large. One of the greatest gifts is that we establish a relationship with a God of our own understanding. With our Higher Power, all is possible.

No longer controlled by anger and fear, our lives are filled with peace of mind and a welcomed concern for others. We finally become useful people and serve as a vessel for good. Our life's hopes and dreams become possible to achieve.

As our spirits awaken, we become the people we were meant to be all along. We keep the precious gifts of our enlightenments by sharing them with others who seek our guidance

In This Moment: With the help of Narcotics Anonymous and the fellowship, we receive the gift of recovery. We share these gifts with others in recovery and we find our lives superior to anything we have ever known.

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January 8

Our deepest longing and recurring images of the kind of people
We'd like to be are only glimpses of God's will for us."

Gray Book p. 58 (Step Eleven L 18-20)

Our eleventh step in the Grey Book states our conscious
contact with our Higher Power reveals God's will for us can
become our will for ourselves.

This, of course, takes place over time, not overnight,
Aligning of God's will with ours is only possible through
the transformation that takes place as a result of living
the principles of the steps and traditions of Narcotics
Anonymous. While living the spiritual principles of the
Seventh Step, we start to see glimpses of ourselves temporarily
free of certain defects. This revelation gives us
hope that freedom from the bond of selfishness is possible.

We sense our Higher Power wants us to be healthy,
prosperous, and never alone. These are the things we always
wanted for ourselves. Our experience demonstrates a new way of
life is possible. We are still being molded and shaped.
This process will continue for the rest of our journey if we
work the steps and apply the principles in our lives.

Just for today, there is hope for us to be all we can
be. This hope translates into faith as we trust the God of our
own understanding. Our higher power will do for us what we
cannot do for ourselves.

To continue progressing in our recovery we must work with
others as we share this precious gift with the still suffering
addict.

In This Moment: The glimpses of the people we
could be give us the hope we need to continue changing.

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January 9

"Personality change is a natural progression set in motion by our surrender to the program.

Gray Book p: 81 (Chapter Fine L: 4-5)

When we first arrived at a Narcotics Anonymous meeting, we were told the only thing we had to change was everything. This seemed impossible to us because when we were using, the drugs made all the decisions for us. We were not free to make up our own minds. The disease of addiction guided our every thought and action. We were controlled. We were powerless.

In Narcotics Anonymous, we surrender to the program's spiritual principles because our way never worked well for us. The steps and traditions of Narcotics Anonymous can reconstruct our broken personalities. With the help of our Higher Power and our sponsors, we go back in time to when we first picked up, and nurture our lost spirits, which in turn, starts to awaken.

The fourth step provides the information and is the vehicle we need to recognize our patterns. This awareness can set us on the right path of change. Since a sick mind cannot cure itself, we need the help of the God of our understanding and others. Taking the correct actions, we start to live our way into thinking differently. Since we live what we believe, we start to change little by little. This is a "just for today" transformation.

We could always revert to our old personalities if we fail to practice these principles in our daily affairs. Narcotics Anonymous helps us create a new past, filled with hope, freedom, and joy instead of active addiction and its consequences.

In This Moment: We will continue to surrender to win. The change in our personalities will be over time, not overnight.

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January 10

"We come to understand that our recovery is a gift from a power greater than ourselves."

Gray Book, p.11 (Chapter One, L: 11-12)

When most of us finally arrived to Narcotics Anonymous, we were just seeking relief from our painful lives. The drugs stopped working and were causing us pain. Everything we ~~had~~ tried failed, so we were not sure if Narcotics Anonymous was going to work for us either.

We came into NA as drug addicts because we only saw the results of our drug use. Working step one, we realized that we suffered from a disease called addiction. We learned that addiction is a spiritual, mental, and physical disease and the drugs were just a symptom. We also learned that addiction was progressive and fatal and there was no known cure.

In Narcotics Anonymous, we are offered a spiritual solution that could treat our disease which makes recovery possible. Recovery in Narcotics Anonymous leaves us in a better condition than we were in before we started using drugs.

Recovery consists of spiritual principles manifesting in each one of us to arrest this disease. No human power, medicine, or religion could offer us this solution. It is truly a gift from a power greater than ourselves. In order to keep this "a day at a time" momentum going, we must share it with others.

In This Moment: We come to an understanding of this precious gift we call recovery and the source of its power through recovering addicts and empathy.

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January 11

"With our Higher Power guiding us, we may never again have to deal with using, but we will always have to deal with staying clean."

Gray Book p. 147 (Chapter Nine, L: 21-23)

For us getting clean and staying clean are two different things. We thought we could stop anytime we wanted to. There were plenty of times we stopped using drugs, for some time, only to start using again. We used to look at the stopping, and not staying stopped.

Our first step implies if we could not control our drug usage, how could we control our addiction? The obsession to use will remain with us after we abstained from drugs. Only a power greater than ourselves can relieve our obsession to use. This is not anyone's power; this is not medication or religion.

Our second step describes this power as caring and greater than ourselves. Many of us use the group as a whole, as a power greater than we are. Some of us use the spiritual principles of the program, and some of us use nature or the universe. Some of us use all these ideals. We manifest this power as we go to meetings and practice our spiritual principles. This power can also be used to help us change.

We never have to return to active addiction. Staying clean involves more than just not picking up. We never knew we had this choice before. When we tap into this Higher Power in Narcotics Anonymous, we are given our power back. Not over our addiction, but power to practice spiritual principles. Our Gray Book implies meetings, traditions, and step work are a fence around our clean time. Being clean is the cornerstone of our program.

In This Moment: We use the fellowship to get clean, then we use the God of our own understanding to stay clean and grow.

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January 12

"Having had a spiritual awakening as a result of these steps..."

Gray Book p. 59 (Step Twelve Header)

The twelfth step implies our spirits awaken as a result of working and living the steps. After putting down the drugs and working step one, our spirits begin to awaken. The fruit of surrender we experienced as a result of the second step continues awakening our spirit. In step three we gain trust in a Higher Power. We continue to turn our will and life over to the care of the God of our own understanding. With every step and every principle we practice daily, our spirits awaken more and more.

By the time we reach the twelfth step, we are fully awake. The evidence is in the way we live, carry the message, and practice these principles in all our affairs. Our Gray Book states, "The 12 Steps guide us from a state of humiliation and desperation to a state wherein we are able to act as instruments of God's will." This awakening is not once and for all. If we stop living the program and helping others our spirits begin regressing again. The result of our recovery regression can be a return to using drugs.

This relapse of the spirit is subtle. Sometimes it goes unnoticed until we get ourselves into pain again. Our spiritual awakening must remain progressive. We must keep practicing. Recovery is a continuous journey, so we must keep feeding our spirits to remain awake, vigilant, and growing.

In This Moment: If we are not growing, we are going. We must continue to keep our spiritual health progressive.

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January 13

"Recovery begins with the first admission of powerlessness."

Gray Book p. 33 (Step One L 16)

At first we used drugs then drugs used us. We told ourselves we could stop if we wanted to, but that desire never came. Toward the end of our drug use, we just wanted to stop hurting. We told ourselves if it was not for the consequences we would still use. We failed to see that we were not addicts because we used drugs; we used drugs because we were addicts. We were never actually powerless over our addiction; it just manifested in our drug use.

Inside we were just as unmanageable as on the outside. In fact, it was not until we surrendered that we felt inner unmanageability. After attending some meetings, we began to see that a disconnection from a loving higher power was enough of a consequence to stop using.

Our admission in the first step had to be backed up with action. Honesty is a spiritual principle behind this step. Honesty means that we align our actions with the truth. The actions in the steps are what starts the recovery process. The first step implies when we admit our powerlessness and unmanageability, we open the door to

recovery. The opposite is also true: we can also close that door with our inaction, so we must continue with a living program.

In This Moment: When we gain gratitude, it will show as we share and care the NA way. Our admission of powerlessness will follow a continuing surrender that is backed by action.

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January 14

The second step is the most important thing that must happen for us to achieve and sort of ongoing recovery.

Gray Book P: 34 (Step Two L: 12-14)

In Narcotics Anonymous we believe we suffer from a spiritual disease, not a medical one. This disease requires spiritual solutions, not chemical ones. This is the purpose of the second step in Narcotics Anonymous.

Our literature implies that the pain of living without drugs or anything to replace them, forces us to seek a Power greater than ourselves that will help us with the withdrawals and obsessions. In the second step we are introduced to this Power. This Power is necessary to begin to achieve ongoing recovery.

In active addiction we used everything outside ourselves, including drugs to fill our God-sized hole. We came to believe in a Power greater than ourselves to fill the void that complete and total abstinence has left. Narcotics Anonymous suggests that this Power not be us. Some examples we may use are the Groups and the spiritual Principles. We will use this ever-expanding Power greater than ourselves. Whatever we choose, we must be honest, because we will continuously tap into this Power for guidance and strength throughout our recovery.

As we approach the third step, we will start to develop a loving relationship with this Power. This God of our own understanding should be loving, caring, and forgiving. This relationship will be one of the greatest strengths and needs on our journey of recovery.

In This Moment: We will choose a loving, caring power that will fill our void and guide us in our recovery. This relationship begins in the second step.

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January 15

"Life without fear is a gift we receive for the price of acceptance."

Gray Book p. 36 (Step Two L 13-14)

Recovery teaches us how having acceptance will free us from feeling as though we are responsible for the disease. The disease manifests itself in ways that affect our attitudes and behaviors. When we find out that we suffer from a spiritual disease and not a moral dilemma, we start to breathe easier.

In Narcotics Anonymous we meet people who suffered as we had and found hope. The hope we find in Narcotics Anonymous will free us from the fear that we can not stay clean. We accept this disease and the solution as well. As we begin trusting in a Higher Power we no longer live in our fears of the past.

This newfound hope helps us stay in the moment and prevents fear of tomorrow. As we let go and let God, we enforce our initial surrender. Practicing the principle of open-mindedness leads to the very insights that eluded us all our lives.

Fear is replaced by faith as we see evidence of recovering addicts all around us in Narcotics Anonymous. As we accept ourselves, we begin accepting others. We no longer feel alone. We find ourselves among people who suffered from a hopeless state then found a spiritual solution in Narcotics Anonymous.

In This Moment: By sharing this spiritual solution with others we become truly grateful for our new way of life. This gratefulness is shown in the way we live.

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January 16

"We have feared that if we ever revealed ourselves as we really were, we would surely be rejected."

Gray Book p. 44 (Step Five L. 14-15)

Most of us came to Narcotics Anonymous with low self-esteem. Using drugs was our solution for the feelings we had about ourselves. Feelings of uselessness and not fitting in happened to us years before we picked up drugs. Using drugs seemed to offer some relief; it helped mask our negative feelings of ourselves and others.

When the drugs stopped working we used more to cover up the shaken, frightened people we really were. We rejected ourselves, and we thought we would have been rejected by others if they really got to know us. For us, isolation became our way of life; we felt all alone.

After arriving to Narcotics Anonymous we heard the experiences of others, began to identify and started feeling hope. Feeling a part of the fellowship we empathized with others.

After taking a fifth step with another human, we started losing our fears about others getting to know us as we really are. We started to develop compassion for others, accepting them where they are.

The members that were here before us loved us unconditionally as we started to loving ourselves. As we practice the spiritual principles contained in the steps with our sponsors and the God of our own understanding, we found self-acceptance

In This Moment: Through self-acceptance we stop rejecting ourselves. We will also lose the fear of being rejected by others. Today in the fellowship we are not alone.

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January 17

"We were searching for an answer. We reached out and found the hand of Narcotics Anonymous."

Gray Book page 25 (Why Are We Here, Lines 24-25)

We were looking for something, though we didn't know what it was yet. We came to our first meeting not knowing we were lost. We just wanted to stop hurting. Not knowing what to expect, we were apprehensive. Though our first meeting was not what we thought. We were glad it was not what we really expected.

We had expectations, but feeling welcomed was not one of them. We were invited in, at the door, setting us at ease a little bit. Then we heard others speaking about some ideas we had thought. Wow! Hearing from others, having thoughts and feelings like ours, made us feel a little more comfortable.

We had not felt this welcomed or understood maybe ever. We introduced ourselves to the group. The next meeting someone called us by our name. Wow! Someone, anyone, remembered our name? Amazing! They all told us: "Keep coming back!". After someone else shared to the group, they were also told "Keep coming back!" Could we have finally found a place that would accept us as we really were? There and then we decided to continue showing up at meetings.

At our next meeting we found ourselves asking questions. Eventually we even laughed about our exploits with others. Then, after a meeting one evening we were asked if we wanted to go out after the meeting for coffee and pie. After all this and more, we realize we really do belong in the NA Fellowship.

In This Moment: Feeling welcomed and energetic about Narcotics Anonymous and the fellowship, we share with others how we feel about NA.

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January 18

"Continuing to take personal inventory means that we form a habit of looking at ourselves..."

Gray Book P. 57 (Step Ten L. 14-15)

Our tenth step implies we continue to take a personal inventory. All the steps in Narcotics Anonymous are inventory steps. Starting from step one, we looked at our using and the trouble it caused us. In step two we began looking at others to help us come to believe in a power greater than ourselves. In the third we decided to accept guidance from a God of our own understanding. In step four we began looking at our past relationships with people, places, things and our relationship with reality.

On step five, we saw what we had become, and with the help of our sponsors and our Higher Power, we worked toward our personality change in steps six, and seven. Recovery in Narcotics Anonymous is a daily reprieve, so, living the steps is a continuous cycle. We continue monitoring our attitudes and behaviors and apply the correct principles for change. Recovery in Narcotics Anonymous is a constant removal and replacing old with the new.

We get in the habit of looking at ourselves and practicing these spiritual principles, until this habit becomes automatic. Our lives are transformed. We become different people.

In This Moment: We will continue practicing the habit of looking at ourselves through a tenth step inventory.

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January 19

"As we begin to live in the present, burdens of the past and anxieties of the future slip away."

Gray Book P. 147 (Chapter Nine L 26-28)

As active addicts we obsessed about everything. It is the disease of addiction. We never lived in the moment even when we were getting loaded; our minds were always thinking about the next drug use. Not living in the moment caused us to live a life filled with emotional instability. We caused our own chaos. The disease of addiction had us in its grip.

When we found Narcotics Anonymous, we were told to live in the here and now. It was not easy to stop thinking about the wreckage of our past. We were not too thrilled about the future either. Feeling doomed and hopeless, we returned to a God of our own understanding to relieve our obsessions.

Living the program allows us to focus on the present moment. We again begin feeling that all will be well. We no longer feel the need to carry the burdens of the past or the worries of the future. While turning our will and life over to the care of God as we understand Him, our faith grows. Through faith, we continue living in the here and now.

In This Moment: Serenity happens by trusting God. This will give us the ability to live in the moment.

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January 20

"At last, with the help of the fellowship and our higher power, we have regained our freedom."

Gray Book p. 160 (Chapter Ten, L. 27-28)

As using addicts, we lived in our self-made prisons. The disease of addiction had us trapped in a vicious cycle: the getting and using and finding the means to use more. The disease had trapped us in our own minds.

We gave up a little of ourselves every time we used. We had no control. We were slaves to addiction, and saw no way out. We became hopeless and helpless. Our prison was self-imposed, and surrender to Narcotics Anonymous was the key.

After finding Narcotics Anonymous we were told we never had to use again. We never realized that was a choice. After completing our first step, we were relieved of our drug use. That alone saved our lives, but it was not enough. We needed freedom from our mental prisons.

The first step was the key to opening our closed minds. The second step prepared us to surrender. The third step gave us the courage to put that surrender into action. With the help of our sponsors and the God of our own understanding, we continued working the Narcotics Anonymous program.

With each step we experience more freedom. Each day we surrender at a deeper level. Surrender had to be followed by action to be complete and total. We applied these principles and found hope.

In This Moment: We realized drugs were no longer the answer. We found freedom in Narcotics Anonymous and we must continue this path to keep it

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January 21

"Unity is a reality in Narcotics Anonymous."

Gray Book p. 91 (Tradition One, L. 32)

We gather in the spirit of unity. Unity means oneness and it welcomes diversity. It is a spiritual principle that we must practice. When we put our common welfare first, our personal welfare benefits.

Our personal welfare depends on our shared purpose. We find strength in togetherness. We cannot recover alone. Our self sufficient attitudes had to go. Without unity we found our lives reverting back to selfish ways. Those who isolate from the fellowship find rough roads back to pain and misery. Staying active in the fellowship promotes unity and that helps us stay clean.

With the help of sponsorship we experience unity unlike anything we have ever known. This relationship helps us to reach out to others in the local fellowship. We also go to meetings out of town and we strengthen our unity there also.

In our new way of life it is important to remain connected with others on a similar path. Although how we got here differs from one addict to the next, we find common themes in our recovery. As we work our programs and continue to be of service to the fellowship, we support the survival of Narcotics Anonymous as a whole.

In This Moment: We will put the common welfare of Narcotics Anonymous in front of our individual wants. No one person is more important than Narcotics Anonymous as a whole.

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January 22

"We want to learn to do the things that will transform us into self-affirming people."

Gray Book p. 26 (Chapter Three L. 32-33)

The Basic Text implies Narcotics Anonymous is a program for learning. It is also a program for unlearning. For most of us while in active addiction, our perceptions and perspectives changed. Our literature implies that during active addiction, we forgot social graces. Our living skills were reduced to the animal level. We acquired and learned strange habits and mannerisms. It continues to describe how we forgot to play, feel, and show concern for others.

The disease of addiction is not a moral dilemma. It affected most of us. Our spirit was broken before we began using drugs. Our burdened spirit was probably the main reason we used in the first place. Now clean and practicing the spiritual principles contained in the steps and traditions of Narcotics Anonymous, we have to begin all over again.

The only thing we have to change about ourselves is everything. First, we learn not to use drugs, then we learn about ourselves, others, the world around us, and most importantly, we learn with each other.

As we continue in our journey, we are constantly reforming and challenging our thoughts, feelings, and actions.

In This Moment:

We will unlearn our ways from active addiction. NA is a program for learning about ourselves, others, and a God of our own understanding. We will continue learning this new way of life, and about God's will for us.

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January 23

"This lack of daily maintenance can show up in many ways."

Gray Book p. 144 (Chapter Nine L. 21-22)

The program of Narcotics Anonymous is a twenty-four hour program. We arrest the disease of addiction just for today. We renew our commitment to our recovery on a daily basis. When we go to bed at night, we review our day, our actions, reactions, and attitudes. We check where we could have handled situations better than we did.

We take inventory to see if we need to make an amends to someone. This consistent monitoring of our attitudes and behaviors is only half of our daily maintenance. The other half of our daily maintenance is the actual practice of our spiritual principles in all our affairs.

We start the next day as soon as we open our eyes. We start with gratitude for waking up. We ask for the strength from the God of our own understanding, to walk the walk. The more we live the spiritual principles embodied in the Narcotics Anonymous program, the less chance our disease will get the best of us.

The relapse process usually begins with the loss our spirituality. We stop being grateful for the things we have. We stop praying. We start to lose patience with people, places, and things. Worrying becomes prayer replacement.

Our behavior with ourselves and others will begin to change, then the chaos starts. A lapse in our spirituality can lead to physical relapse. A return to the basics is the only thing that can save us at this point. Taking an immediate inventory can keep us on the right track to move forward.

We reconnect with our Higher Power. We renew our surrender to the principles of Narcotics Anonymous, and the recovery process begins again. Helping another suffering addict gets us out of our diseased thinking.

In This Moment: We will continue moving forward on this spiritual path by continuing to surrender. We will practice these spiritual principles just for today.

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January 24

"Addiction isolated us from people except for the getting, using, and finding ways and means to get more."

Gray Book p. 7 (Chapter One L. 12-13)

In active addiction as our using progressed, our world seemed to get smaller and smaller. As time went on and our disease progressed, we used to live and lived to use. We lost our jobs and became separated from our families and friends. Toward the end we spent a lot of time involved in getting and using drugs. When we ran out of drugs, we spent all our time finding ways and means to get more.

One of the traits of addiction is isolation. The disease separated us from our loved ones. Some of us no longer enjoyed hobbies or leisure activities. We forgot how to have fun. Using became our priority and we felt we had no choice in our own destruction. We were powerless over our addiction, and our lives became unmanageable.

Many of us became homeless and found ourselves in the streets living in degradation. The most painful part was the isolation our spirits suffered. We had lost ourselves.

Eventually, we found Narcotics Anonymous meetings. We found people similar to us in N A. We finally felt apart of something special. We no longer felt alone. This was the of the end of our isolation. With the help of Narcotics Anonymous, our world began to grow. Some of us became employable, and some of us got our families back. We began to make new friends and participated in our lives, carrying us forward in our new spiritual journey.

Moving forward, we must live the principles of Narcotics Anonymous. We must also share this gift with those suffering addicts that seek help. We never have to feel isolated again. In Narcotics Anonymous we are never alone.

In This Moment: Our lives as recovering addicts consists of fellowship, family, friends, and our Higher Power. Today we choose recovery instead of isolation.

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January 25

"The only way to be rid of a resentment is to develop
humility, in the form of forgiveness

Gray Book p. 76 (Step Twelve L. 10-11)

Resentment is an internal burden that only weighs down the one carrying it. We must begin the process of forgiving ourselves and others. We started our transformation when we admitted our powerlessness over our addiction. We refine and strengthen our resolve in steps six and seven. At this point, we are able to forgive and be forgiven by others. Our resentments start fading.

We become accountable for our addiction. We also become more willing for recovery when we ask the God of our own understanding to relieve our obsession too use. Our decision to turn our will and life over to God is the beginning of humility.

Asking for help made us aware of our own humanity as we develop compassion for others. Patience and tolerance with ourselves helps us to practice these principles toward others.

Forgiving others releases us from the bondage of resentment. We begin seeing that forgiveness is really for ourselves.

In This Moment: We are released from our resentments by forgiving others. Today with the program and our Higher Power we can live happy, joyous, and free.

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January 26

"We went from a state of drugged success and well-being to complete spiritual, mental and emotional bankruptcy."

Gray Book p. 13 (Chapter One L. 28-30)

At first, we used drugs and then drugs used us. Upon our spiritual awakening, our experiences show us that the disease was present long before we used drugs. Step four revealed that we suffered from a disease that led to spiritual decay.

For a while many of us thought drugs were the solution; they saved us from ourselves. The drugs helped us survive our feelings and our emotions. We used drugs to fill the void in our lives. The drugs only made our void larger and our lives more painful.

After a while, the drugs stop working. The drugs started using us. Using drugs became our way of life. We suffered emotionally, spiritually, mentally, physically, and our lives became unmanageable. Many of us ended up in jail, institutions, degradation and some died.

After trying everything with no success, we stumbled into Narcotics Anonymous. For most of us, it was the last house on the block. In NA, we met people who, like us, suffered from the horrors of addiction. The NA fellowship had a solution and shared it with us.

The first thing we had to do was stop using drugs in any form. This leaves a hole inside. We must seek something to fill the void the drugs left. Realizing a power greater than ourselves could relieve us of our obsession to use is essential.

We found our solution that eluded us all our lives. A spiritual solution to a spiritual problem called addiction. Our spirits awaken and we come to know a life we never realized was possible before. Recovery in NA leaves us in a better condition than before we got sick. We are welcomed back to the land of the living. We share this message of hope and promise of freedom with others to keep our precious gift.

In This Moment: We will stay in the solution.
We will keep

our spiritual awakening progressing by continuing to practice the program.

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January 27

"These old ways have to go if we are to find new lives."

Gray Book p. 80 (Chapter Five L. 19)

Our character defects were the tools of addiction. These defects made it possible for us to survive our old way of life. Drugs were our solution for a long time before they turned against us. To survive our addiction, we lived by our defects.

Narcotics Anonymous is more than just not using drugs and it is not a drug program. NA is a recovery program. In Narcotics Anonymous we are given a new set of tools and they are necessary for our new way of life. Some useful tools are spiritual awakenings, a relationship with a Higher Power, and a relationship with reality. Our old tools do not work in our recovery. Our Gray Book states, "Letting go of character defects should be done with love."

Fear and hate cannot give us new lives. We no longer need those old survival skills as we are now doing more than just surviving; we are beginning to live rightly. Narcotics Anonymous offers us simple spiritual principles we must practice to continue on this spiritual path.

In This Moment: We must keep these new tools polished by continuously using them and sharing them with others or we revert to our old ways.

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January 28

"The progression of the disease is an ongoing process, even during abstinence, no matter how long."

Gray Book p. 128 (Chapter Seven L. 32-33)

Our literature implies that we have an incurable disease called addiction. It persists for a long time. It is progressive and fatal. The disease is treatable therefore there is hope. In Narcotics Anonymous the first thing we do is stop using drugs.

For us, recovery cannot happen unless we are completely and totally abstinent from all drugs. This is a must, if we are to treat the disease. We suffer from a physical, mental, spiritual and emotional problem which needs a spiritual solution. We arrest the disease on a daily basis when we use spiritual principles to recover from the state of hopelessness. We get a daily reprieve depending on our spiritual condition. Each day our recovery resets when we open our eyes and breathe in a new day. Excited, we continue doing the things that worked the day before.

No matter how long we have been recovering and abstinent, disease is progressing and waiting for an opportunity to resurface. Our vigilance develops through surrender and action. We begin to experience freedom from diseased thinking, and we begin to feel serenity as we live by spiritual principles.

In This Moment: Once admitting our powerlessness and unmanageability, we open the door to recovery. There is Hope. Just for today, we do recover.

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January 29

"Do we understand and believe that we have no real, long term control over drugs?"

Gray Book p. 31 (Step One L. 23-25)

If we have no control over drugs, how can we tell ourselves that one day we can use drugs successfully again? One of the ways the disease of addiction manifests itself is in our drug use. Drug use is only one symptom of the disease. This disease affects our spiritual, emotional, mental, and physical state. We are not addicts because we use drugs, we used drugs because we are addicts.

Drug use usually comes at the end of the relapse process. The relapse process begins once we stop using some of the principles embodied in the NA program. Chapter Seven in the Basic Text describes the process that starts the spiritual, emotional, mental, and physical decay that occurs before drug use.

Addiction is a progressive, incurable and fatal disease that affects every area of our lives. The most obvious sign of the disease is uncontrollable obsession. After that it is just a matter of time unless we do the things needed to arrest this disease that we begin using drugs again.

We are granted a daily reprieve from active drug use. This reprieve is dependent on our continuous spiritual maintenance consisting of actions and steps suggested in the Narcotics Anonymous program.

For us, the idea we can ever return to safely using drugs must be shattered. These reservations are sometimes hidden beyond our consciousness and can only be accessed by practicing the principles. The actions we take in Narcotics Anonymous relieves our obsession to use drugs. These Actions also keep our spiritual awakening and recovery progressing.

In This Moment: Through our actions and honesty, we enforce our belief that we never have to use drugs again, just for today.

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January 30

"...giving away that which has been given to us -- is our best possible insurance against relapse..."

Gray Book p. 59 (Step Twelve L. 21-23)

In Narcotics Anonymous carrying the message of hope to the sick and suffering addict, not only helps save their life, but ours as well. Since the message is meaningless unless we live it. We surely need to practice what we teach. In Narcotics Anonymous we are given the gift that keeps on giving, as long as we keep giving it. One of the ways we carry the message is staying clean. Our surrender of powerlessness over the disease of addiction gives suffering addicts hope that they too can arrest the disease, and then surrender to the principles of N.A. Our surrender to NA principles offers the suffering addict hope in also surrendering into our way of life.

Our time on the program serves as a powerful example to others. When others share their recovery with us, it helps reinforce what they have gained. This way of life and the spiritual awakenings we experience are a result of those and other steps. This program is truly a gift from the God of our own understanding.

We keep giving our gift to those seeking recovery. In turn, our gift will keep bringing us blessings. As our spirit awakens, we practice the principles of love and service by continuing to help others. Carrying the message of Narcotics Anonymous is the real reason the program exists. This is all we have to offer. This is our primary purpose.

In This Moment: Our best insurance against relapse is living the principles of Step Twelve. This step, along with Tradition Twelve, encompasses our entire program.

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January 31

"JUST FOR TODAY I will have faith in someone in N.A. who believes in me and wants to help me in my recovery."

Gray Book p.143 Chapter Nine, Just For Today)

In Narcotics Anonymous, the heart of recovery from addiction is one addict helping another. This is what sponsorship is about, it is a two-way street because it helps both, sponsee and sponsor. When we share our recovery with someone else, we enforce our own recovery. When we first came to Narcotics Anonymous our spirits were broken, we felt helpless and hopeless.

Here, in N.A., we met people that felt like us but had found a daily reprieve from that hopeless feeling. We were told that we did not have to suffer anymore, we did not have to use, just for that day. We were told that we were not bad people trying to get good; we were sick people trying to get better.

The 'we' of the program helps save our lives. The disease had isolated us, and we thought we would die alone and using. Our literature implies that Narcotics Anonymous is like a ship in the sea of isolation. We are not alone, together we are shipwrecked on the same island. We help each other survive from the horrors of addiction that we experienced.

One of the suggestions in Narcotics Anonymous is that we find a sponsor to guide us through the steps and traditions. The Basic Text states: "The ultimate weapon for recovery is the recovering addict."

A sponsor is like a human map; they know where we came from. They know where we are going, and they show us how to get there. People in Narcotics Anonymous will walk side by side with us, without motives. Just for today, we never have to be alone again. Just for today, we will have faith in someone in N.A.

In This Moment: We will seek to be part of this fellowship. We will choose a person that can guide us through the Narcotics Anonymous Program and into a new way of life.